

Class Exercise 13: Introductions-Revisions

Instructions: **Work with and revise small portions** of your introduction draft and **discuss** with your partner a plan of action for future revisions.

Requirements: To successfully complete this exercise, you are required to:

1. **identify** and **reflect upon** your writing decisions (e.g., text choices, organization)
2. **dissect** the narrowing of your research question(s) from your provided background literature
3. **answer** short prompt questions

Please use a **word processing program** (such as MS Word) to complete this exercise.

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Introduction Draft: Identification, Reflection

Now that a little time has passed since submitting your Intros, it is time to return with fresh eyes to your writing. The best way to do this is to *distance yourself from your own words*. Try to complete this exercise by *tricking your brain* into thinking that you are reviewing someone else's writing. As a starting point: we all have room for improvement in our writing, and **revisions are a necessary component to successful, accessible writing**.

1. Within your partnership, please first identify the strongest/best sentence(s) or section(s) you

have written in your introduction. Reflect on what made the sentence(s)/section(s) so good: was it the string of words together? The organization of the paragraph? A strong argument? something else?

Our second paragraph was probably our best; it contained correct information in a concise and accurate manner, and it helped set up our following claims well. We defined our terms and explained the prior research that led to our experimental process.

2. Now do a similar thing and identify the weakest sentence(s) or section(s) you have written. Can you articulate what exactly leaves you unsatisfied with these words: do they not capture the ideas you want to convey well? Is the part not supported enough with evidence to make the claims you are making? something else?

Our fourth paragraph was the one we struggled with the most. We wanted to use this paragraph to discuss our second research question and the study we wanted to build off of. In this paragraph we did not effectively convey the methods of the study, or the results. A consequence of that was that it loosely tied into our research question and the relationship was not explicitly clear.

Work here in your document to revise **both** the “strongest” and “weakest” sentence(s). Briefly describe below how you implemented each revision.

Strongest (Paragraph 2): I went more in depth into what an apology truly is. Also, I made sure to reference a different study in regard to the effect of apologies on forgiveness.

Weakest (Paragraph 4): In this paragraph, I rewrote the overall structure and contents. The idea for this paragraph was to build off of the post-transgressional response idea and to introduce a study which had valuable results that tie into our experiment. The changes I made was first to include a more in depth procedure and go into more detail about what the researchers did and how/why they did it. Then, I went over the results and how the implications could be related to our own research process.

3. Sometimes revisions necessitate the adding and/or removing (i.e., deleting) of written text. Please reflect here on how comfortable you are in the present moment with changing your introduction by:
 - adding new text (e.g., adding more detail to the summary of a study)
 - moving around sentences/paragraphs (e.g., changing organization of

broader draft)

- deleting text (e.g., rewriting larger portions of the draft such as multiple sentences or an entire section)

We are very comfortable with making all of these changes and recognize that it is just a part of the writing process. This will only serve to make our introduction stronger and more organized.

For you personally, what is the greatest challenge you face when revising your writing?

Thomas – I would honestly say having to read back into the studies to find supporting arguments for our own study.

Jacob – I think keeping the organization of the study and making sure it was a smooth transition in a funneled direction as somewhat challenging. Having to introduce each idea and include a correlated study that was relevant.

Introduction Draft: Organization

A good way to think about the *flow* (logic building) of your introduction section is to consider your introduction as a funnel (image below). At the largest point of the funnel is the broader introduction of the topics of interest to provide your reader with general background knowledge. And at each level, you narrow in on more specific content that serves a specific purpose for setting up the narrowest point of the funnel, which is your experimental research question(s) and hypotheses. **There can be multiple ways to successfully guide your reader to your research question(s).**



If needed, please go back to the introduction of our base paper

(Ludwig et al., 2022) to see how the researchers set up the organization (e.g., labeled sections) to create their funneling.

4. With your partner, work to *deconstruct* the organization of the logical arguments you make within and across paragraphs in your introduction draft that designate each *level* of your intro funnel. Below, type out the **specific arguments you make at each level** that guide your reader to narrow in on why your experiment is needed.

For example, most partnerships might begin broadly by introducing conflict resolution and why it is important to study, and identifying the goals of your research (this would be considered a *narrowing* to the next level of the funnel).

[add text here to create your funnel; type each narrowing argument on a new line to recreate the flow of your introduction]

Level 1: Apologies are important to induce forgiveness

Level 2: Intellectual humility may be linked to apology quality

Level 3: Preemptive forgiveness can influence apology behavior

Level 4: There may be a relation between preemptive forgiveness and intellectual humility on apology quality

Level 5: Link the arguments from all these previous levels to our current study.

Hold a 10-15 minute discussion with your partner. Here are some guiding questions to answer following your deconstruction:

- *How might your group have areas of your draft that fail to narrow the topic when needed? How might these confuse your reader; for example, what would a reader predict your study would be about given how you narrow in your introduction? Regarding your opening paragraph, do you communicate the importance of the research and introduce your study (a reader should know what your study is about without having to read too far)*
- *How is your group **connecting** previous studies to support the*

arguments at each level? Reflect on whether your draft includes text that only summarizes a previous finding or also combines findings. Do you demonstrate your thinking around why an IV should be linked to a DV, while providing support for that connection?

- *Regarding the interaction—whether the effect of IH on apologies depends on the victim's response to an offense—do you demonstrate your thinking around why this might be?*
- We could have benefited a lot from making a funnel structure before writing our introduction
- We need to go more in depth on the relevant studies, making sure to include methods and results in everything. This links back to our first point.
- Building off of the results, we could have described the relationships between the findings better, as well as tying it into our final results.
- Having a funnel structure would have helped us figure out where to use specific study findings to strengthen our arguments for each level.
- In terms of describing the interaction, this is where we struggled the most. We plan on revising this part of our introduction and making a clear argument regarding the interaction between IH and the victim's response.

Introduction Draft: Revision Implementation

Revisions to our writing will be an **ongoing** process in this course. Choose one aspect from your group discussion above and revise that portion of your draft. For example, you might choose to revise the organization of your draft by reorganizing full paragraphs, removing a paragraph that does not fit with your logic for your research question(s), generating a new/better transition between levels, rewriting a paragraph that does not connect previous study findings, etc.

Make sure to save your revisions on a shared document.

Optional: your group may choose to submit your Introduction Draft again to Canvas if you would like me to grade based on your revisions today.

